

# OpenAI SMB Channel Partner Marketing & Communications Guidelines

Last updated: Apr 16, 2026

## Overview

SMB Channel Partners play an important role in helping small and medium-sized businesses discover, purchase, deploy, and adopt OpenAI offerings.

As the SMB Channel Partner Program grows, we expect more partner-led marketing, communications, and go-to-market activity. These guidelines establish shared standards for how SMB Channel Partners may reference OpenAI, OpenAI products, and their relationship with OpenAI in external-facing materials. The goal is to protect brand consistency, reduce market confusion, and ensure that partner communications are accurate, clear, and aligned with OpenAI standards.

## Quick checklist for approvals

- ✓ Read this doc fully for understanding on classifications
- ✓ Partners should send to their Partner Director and PDs should send to Marketing and Comms for:
  - a. Logo use
  - b. Partnership requests
  - c. Co-marketing requests

## Process for Approvals

- **Submit request to your Partner Director for approval**
- Include draft language, images, other assets, and proposed timeline for review
- Marketing will respond within 3 business days

Use these rules across any form of co-marketing where OpenAI’s name, logo, or story will be used.

## Common Phrasing Guidance

| Phrase                       | When to Use                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| “OpenAI SMB Channel Partner” | Firms who have signed an OpenAI partner agreement can refer to themselves as OpenAI SMB Channel Partners or that they have a OpenAI SMB Channel Partnership with OpenAI. |

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| “Collaboration” | OpenAI SMB Channel Partners can refer to what they are doing with OpenAI as “collaborating” or “a collaboration” i.e., “[Partner] is a SMB Channel Partner of OpenAI and is excited to announce our new collaboration.” |
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## Classifications

| Situation                                          | Process                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Partner wants to announce the relationship</b>  | <p>Partner lets OAI Partner Director (PD) know that they want to announce the relationship along with proposed channels and announcement date</p> <p>Partner drafts announcement using approved “OpenAI SMB Channel Partner” language</p> <p>Partner sends draft announcement to PD for review at 5 business days in advance</p> <p>PD sends request to Partner Mktg, who reviews draft content and sends to Comms for review and approval</p> |
| <b>Partner wants to do additional PR</b>           | <p>Partner lets PD know they want to do additional PR</p> <p>Partner lets PD know the proposed topic, messaging, channels, and date</p> <p>PD sends to Partner Mktg, who reviews with Comms</p> <p>Partner Mktg sends approval/rejection to PD</p> <p>PD sends to Partner, who drafts content and returns to PD to send to Partner Mktg</p> <p>Partner Mktg reviews draft content and send to Comms for review and approval</p>                |
| <b>Partner wants to use OpenAI logo</b>            | <p>Partner verifies that their use of the OpenAI logo is aligned with guidelines on <a href="https://openai.com/brand">openai.com/brand</a></p> <p>Partner sends to PD, who sends to partner marketing for review and approval</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Partner wants to post on social/blog</b>        | <p>Partner lets PD know that they plan to post on social / blog about their relationship with OAI and shares draft, copy, and post timing.</p> <p>PD shares with Partner Mktg, who reviews, sends to Comms for review, and sends any feedback to PD</p>                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Partner wants OpenAI to post on social/blog</b> | <p>Partner tells PD what they want posted/reposted and target launch date</p> <p>PD sends request to Partner Mktg, including partner-drafted copy or key points</p> <p>Partner Mktg and Comms decide if post aligns with OAI strategy</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

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|                                                                                      | <p>If so, Partner Mktg drafts post, gets Comms review and approval, and returns draft to PD within 3 business days</p> <p>Partner Mktg schedules post and shares live link with PDx</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Partner wants to publish case study or other cowritten content</b>                | <p>Partner informs PD of customer, use-case, key results, and desired timeline (must have customer's preliminary consent)</p> <p>Partner drafts case study using the OpenAI template and secures customer approval and legal sign-off</p> <p>PD submits draft and approvals to Partner Mktg at least 10 business days before release</p> <p>Partner Mktg reviews for brand, product accuracy, and sends to Comms for final approval</p> <p>Comms approves, Partner Mktg coordinates layout/hosting, and confirms publish date with PD and partner</p>                            |
| <b>Partner wants to launch solution</b>                                              | <p>Partner shares solution brief, value prop, launch assets, and target launch window with PD</p> <p>PD engages Partner Mktg and relevant Product GTM lead to assess technical alignment and messaging</p> <p>Partner finalizes GTM kit (one-pager, demo video, FAQs) using OpenAI guidelines</p> <p>Partner Mktg reviews assets, routes to Comms and Legal for approval, and confirms co-announcement plan</p> <p>Upon approval, Partner Mktg publishes on designated channels and provides enablement materials to Sales</p>                                                   |
| <b>Partner wants to do co-marketing activity (conference, exec engagement, etc.)</b> | <p>Partner submits proposal to PD detailing event type, objectives, target audience, date, and required OpenAI participation</p> <p>PD evaluates fit and capacity, then escalates to Partner Mktg and Events team</p> <p>Partner Mktg reviews budget, messaging, and speaker requirements with Comms and Exec Staff as needed</p> <p>Comms approves talking points, Events team confirms logistics, and Partner Mktg issues final go/no-go to PD</p> <p>If approved, Partner and OpenAI execute joint promo plan, share post-event recap, and capture outcomes for reporting</p> |

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| <b>Partner wants OpenAI speaker for event, webinar, interview, etc.</b> | <p>Partner notifies PD of event, topic, audience, proposed date, and desired speaker at least 6 weeks in advance</p> <p>PD informs Partner Mktg, who reviews strategic fit</p> <p>If event is a fit, Partner Mktg messages desired speaker, their EBP, and/or puts request into #gtm-request-special-guest</p> <p>If desired speaker accepts, Partner provides agenda, talking points, and info to PD</p> <p>PD sends to Partner Mktg, who refines with speaker and sends to PD and Partner</p> |
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## Tone and Voice

### Example of clear, approved phrases:

- ✓ “Our solution uses OpenAI’s GPT-5o model.”
- ✓ “Using OpenAI’s API, we help companies automate customer support.”
- ✗ “In partnership with OpenAI, we launched [product] to [achieve goal].”

### Guidance on tone:

- Stay straightforward and factual.
- Avoid inflated or ambiguous claims.
- Don’t imply joint development or endorsement unless it exists.

| Say.....                                                             | Instead of...                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ✓ “We use OpenAI’s models to support our case law solution.”         | ✗ “We’ve worked with OpenAI to transform AI in law.”              |
| ✓ “Our tool integrates GPT-5o to streamline patient communications.” | ✗ “Our healthcare product is built in collaboration with OpenAI.” |

## Logo Usage

### Allowed:

- Partners who have signed a OpenAI SMB Channel Partner Agreement may use the OpenAI logo (in accordance with our branding guidelines) on their website, sales materials, and certain marketing materials
- Use of the OpenAI logo only allowed for public and highly visible activities like press releases, advertising, events and tradeshow, etc. with OpenAI’s review and explicit approval

- Please send requests for logo usage in announcements and marketing materials to Partner Marketing

#### **Not allowed:**

- On partner product/solution UIs
- If in doubt, use descriptive text instead: “[Company] uses OpenAI models to...”

#### **Endorsements**

OpenAI does not endorse third-party products unless:

- A formal partnership exists, and
- Comms or Marketing has reviewed the messaging and context, and
- It avoids implying OpenAI uses or recommends a customer’s tool or product unless verified and approved

#### **Final thoughts:**

- Don’t publicly refer to OpenAI as a partner, strategic partner, etc. - only as an OpenAI SMB Channel Partner
- Only refer to OpenAI SMB Channel Partners as such if they have signed a formal OpenAI SMB Channel Partner Agreement
- In marketing materials, don’t refer to our our work together as a partnership - only a collaboration
- Don’t imply co-ownership or co-development unless we actively contributed to the solutions
- Don’t claim OpenAI uses your solution unless confirmed and cleared by Marketing or Comms
- Don’t promise exclusivity, endorsements, or certification
- Avoid “endorsed by,” “certified by,” or “trusted by OpenAI”
- Don’t do social posts that pair “OpenAI” with “partner” or “powered by” unless the criteria above are met
- When in doubt - please check with Partner Marketing and Comms

#### **Supporting Materials:**

Brand Guidelines: <https://openai.com/brand/>